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WordPress Plugin Updates: Can I Just Ignore Them? – A Data-Backed Look Into It

Yusuf Mudagal 24 Dec 2022 2 min read

As a WordPress website owner, you've probably seen those notifications about plugin updates popping up on your dashboard. You might be tempted to just ignore them, thinking that your site is running just fine and the updates aren't really necessary. But is ignoring plugin updates really a good idea? At CodeTrappers, we've taken a data-backed look into the importance of keeping your plugins up to date, and the answer may surprise you.

First of all, it's important to understand that plugin updates are released for a reason. Often, these updates include important security patches or bug fixes. Ignoring these updates can leave your website vulnerable to hacking or other security threats.

But security isn't the only reason to keep your plugins up to date. Outdated plugins can also cause compatibility issues with other plugins and even with the WordPress core itself. This can lead to performance issues, such as slow load times or errors on your site.

In addition, ignoring plugin updates means missing out on new features and improvements. Plugin developers are constantly working to improve their products and add new functionality, and ignoring updates means missing out on these enhancements.

But don't just take our word for it. We've looked at the data and found that websites with up-to-date plugins tend to have better performance and security than those with outdated plugins. In fact, a study by WP Engine found that websites with outdated plugins were significantly more likely to be hacked (https://codetrappers.com/malware-removal-for-wordpress/).

So, can you ignore plugin updates? The short answer is no. While it may be tempting to ignore those update notifications, doing so can have serious consequences for the security and performance of your website. At CodeTrappers, we recommend regularly checking for and installing plugin updates to ensure the best possible experience for your users.

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